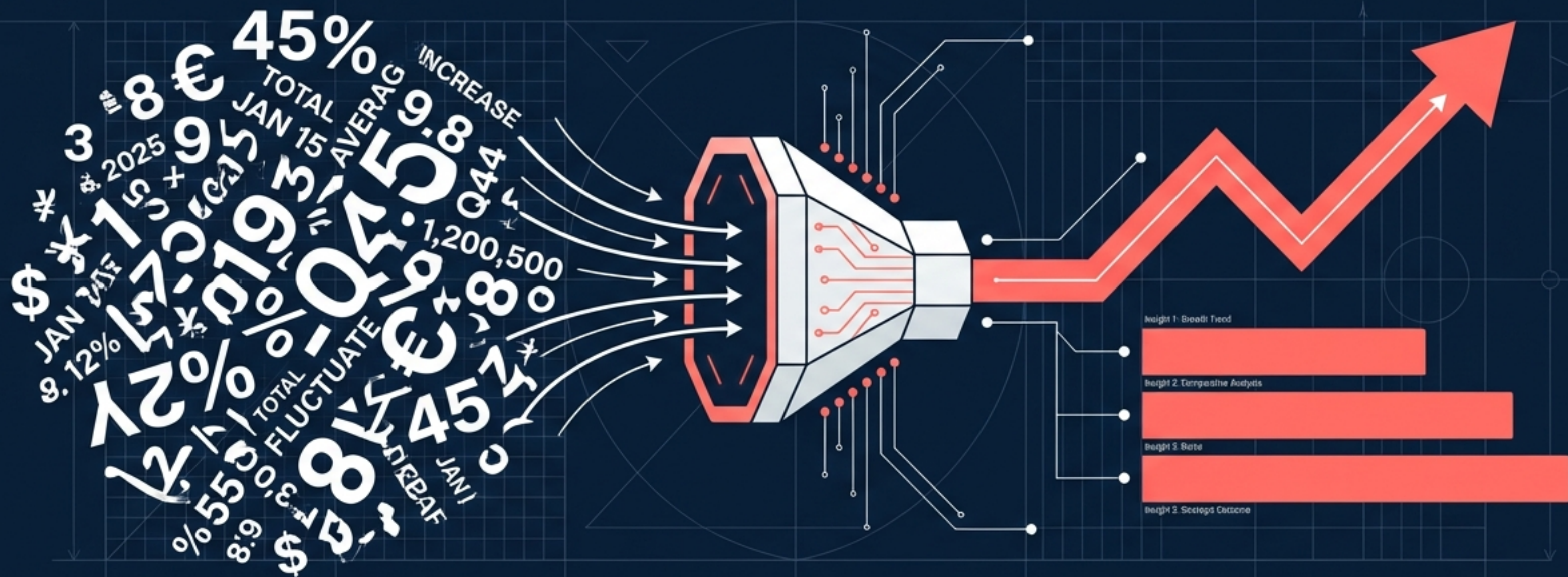


STOP DESCRIBING. START COMPARING.



IELTS Academic Writing Task 1 Masterclass

Target Band 6.0 – 7.5

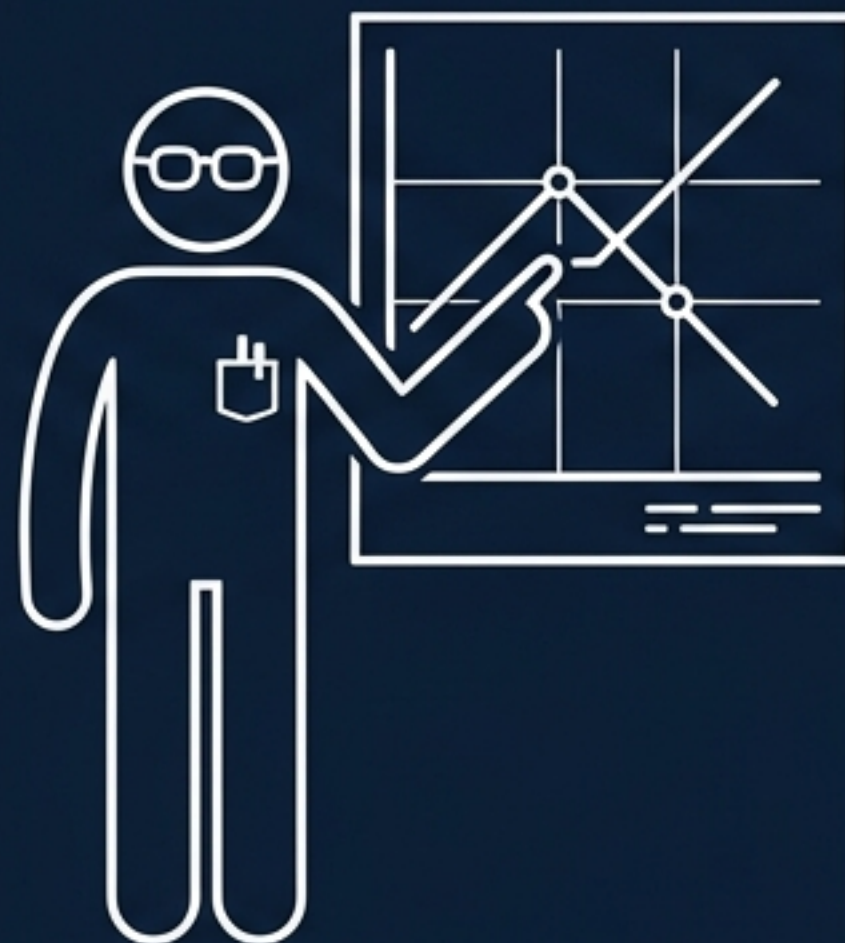
TASK 1 IS NOT A DESCRIPTION TEST

THE REALITY



- Listing numbers = Capped at **Band 6.0**
- Data Dumping
- Mechanical writing

THE GOAL



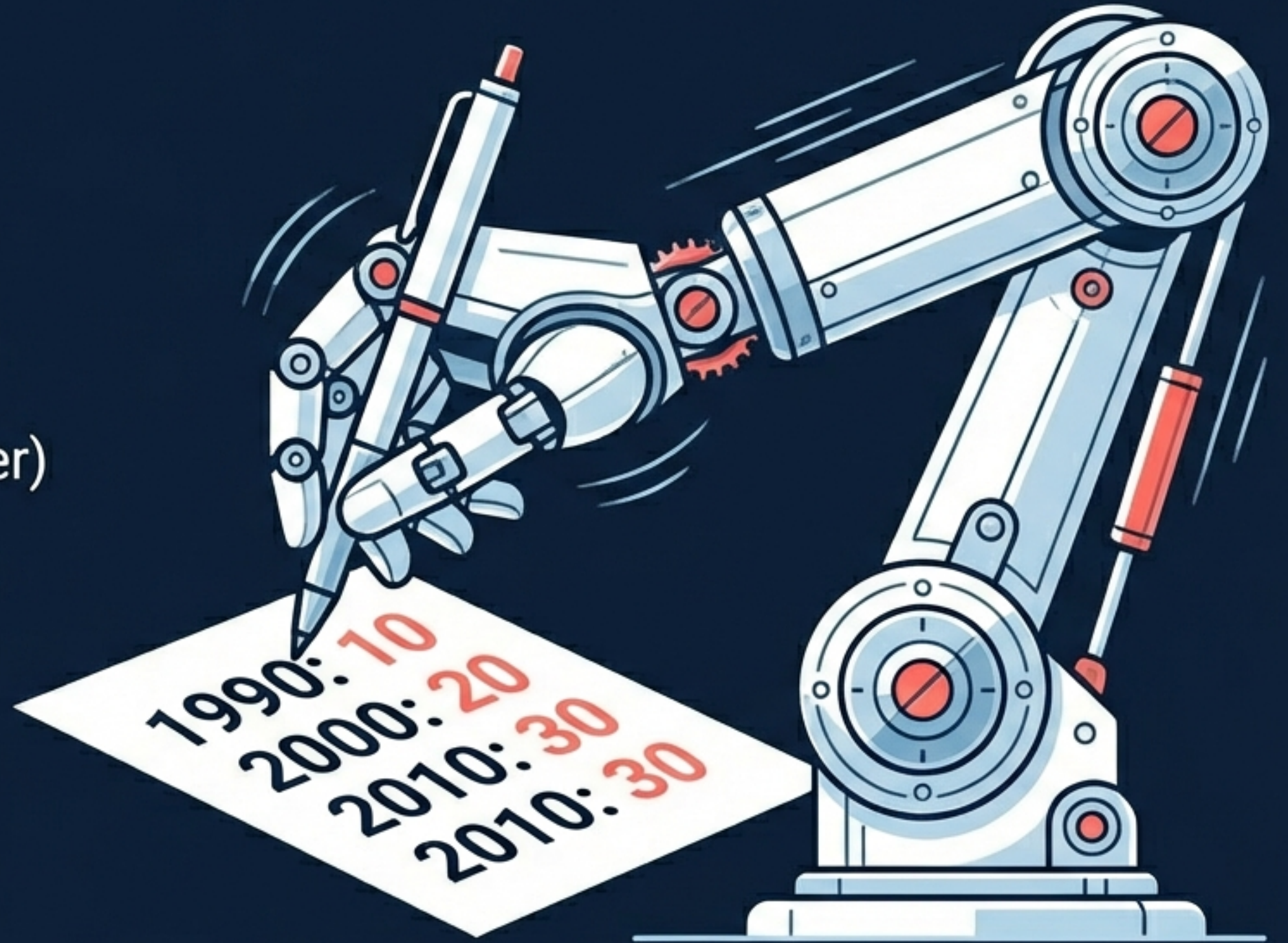
- Transform into an **Analyst**
- Identify Relationships
- Compare, don't just list

TODAY'S MISSION: MASTER THE OVERVIEW & LOGICAL GROUPING

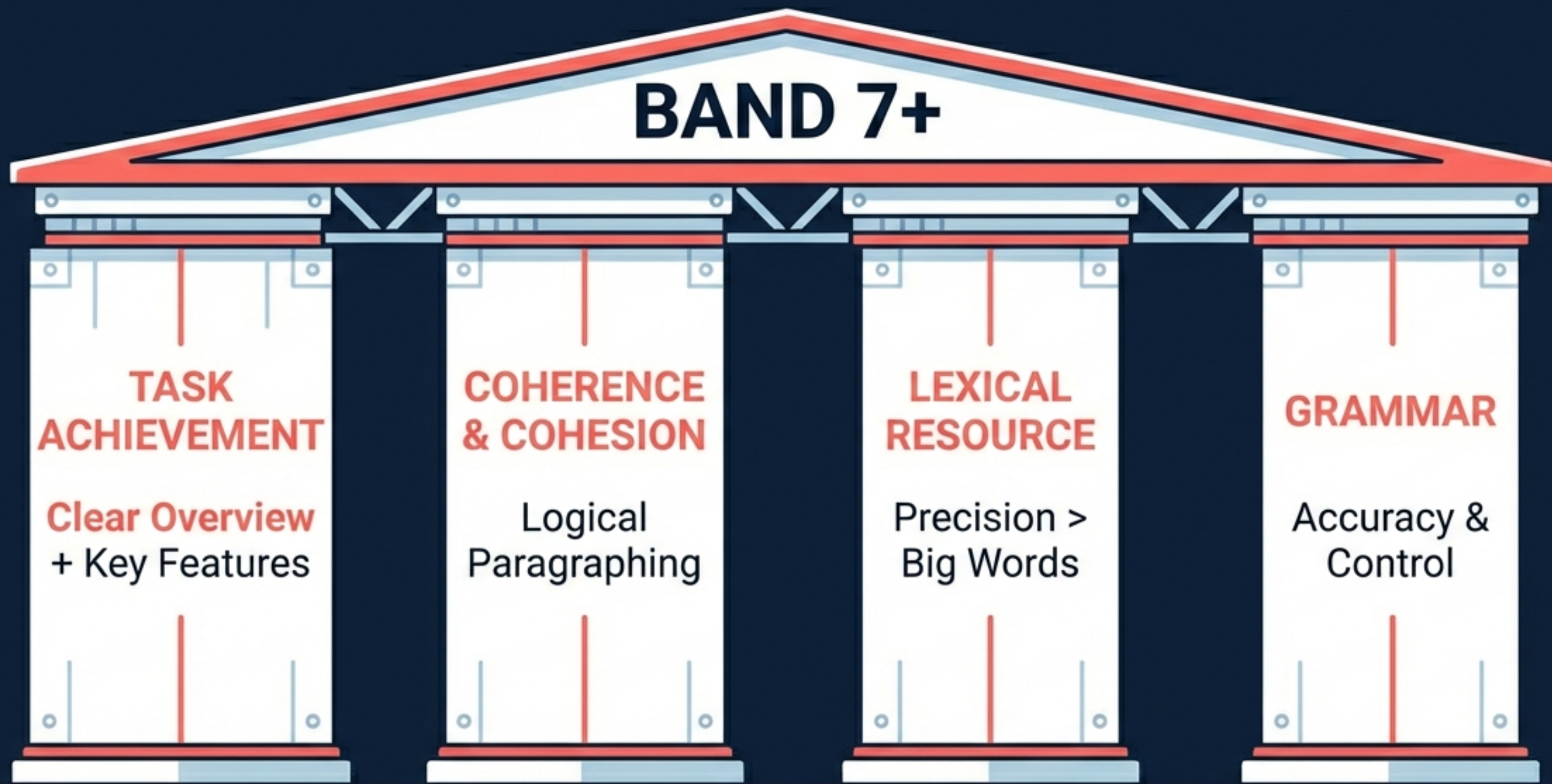
THE 'MECHANICAL' TRAP

Why Marks Are Lost

- **No Clear Overview (The #1 Failure)**
- Data Dumping (Writing every number)
- Robot Writing (In X it was Y...)
- Lack of Comparison



HOW THE EXAMINER THINKS



NO OVERVIEW = NO BAND 7

THE BAND 7+ BLUEPRINT

1. INTRODUCTION

Paraphrase the question (1 sentence).

2. OVERVIEW

The Big Picture. Main trends. NO NUMBERS.

3. DETAIL PARAGRAPH A

First logical group + Comparisons.

4. DETAIL PARAGRAPH B

Second logical group + Comparisons.



**NO CONCLUSION
NEEDED!**

STEP 1: THE INTRODUCTION FORMULA

[Subject] + [Verb] + [Object] + [Time/Place]

Original: The graph shows electricity consumption in England...



Paraphrased: The **line graph illustrates** the **amount of electricity used** in the UK...

Quick Synonyms

- shows → illustrates / compares
- information → data
- proportion → percentage

STEP 2: THE 'BIG PICTURE' (OVERVIEW)

- **Definition:** A summary of main trends, differences, or stages.
- **Rule #1:** NEVER put specific numbers (dates/stats) here. 
- **Rule #2:** Look for “Highest/Lowest” and “General Trend”.
- **Placement:** Paragraph 2 (After Intro).



THE OVERVIEW FORMULA



Full Example:

Overall, it is clear that car ownership increased in all countries, with the USA seeing the most dramatic growth.

SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

WEAK (Band 5/6)

The graph shows car ownership. In 1990 it was 50%, then it went to 60% in 2000 and 70% in 2010.



Too detailed. Mechanical.
Contains numbers.

STRONG (Band 7+)

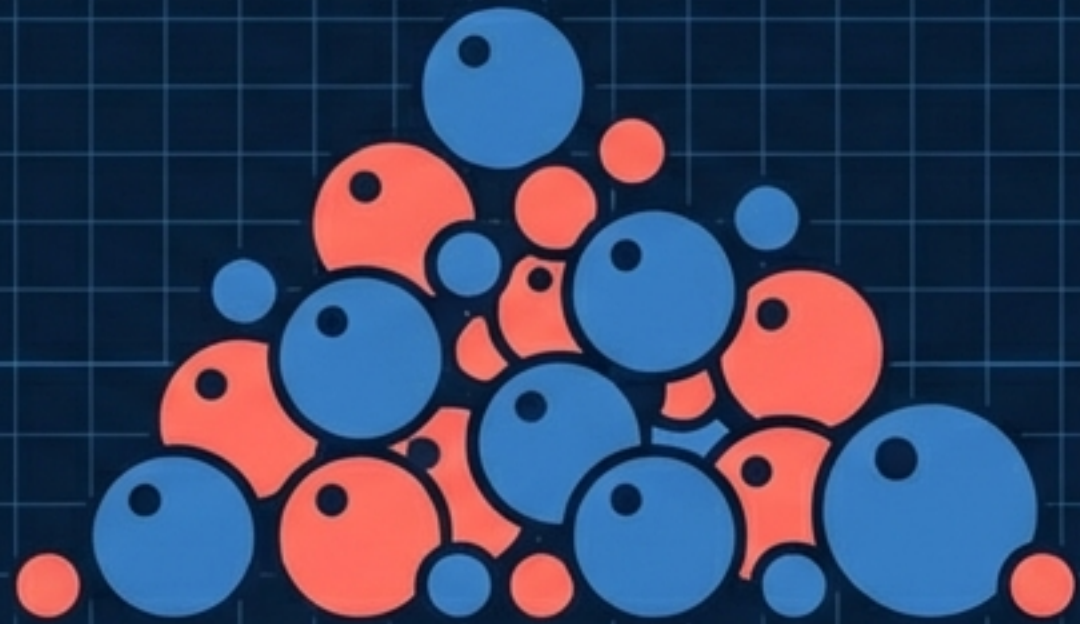
Overall, car ownership experienced a steady upward trend throughout the period, while motorcycle usage declined.



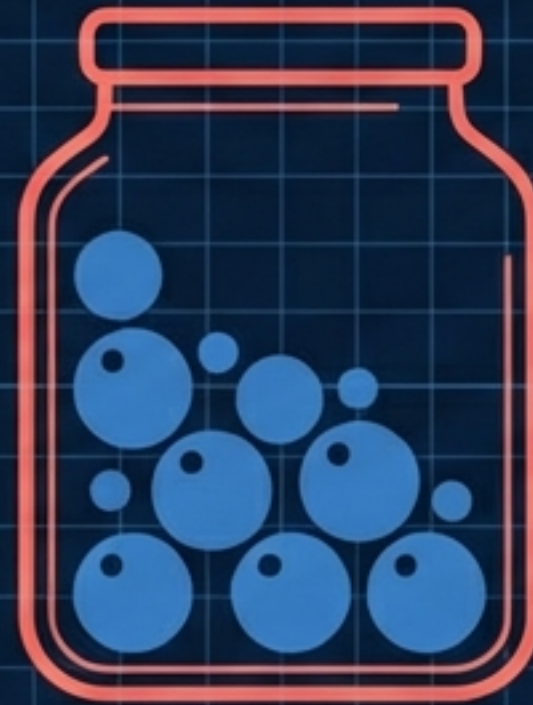
Clear trend. No numbers.
Comparative language.

STEP 3: ORGANIZE, DON'T AGONIZE

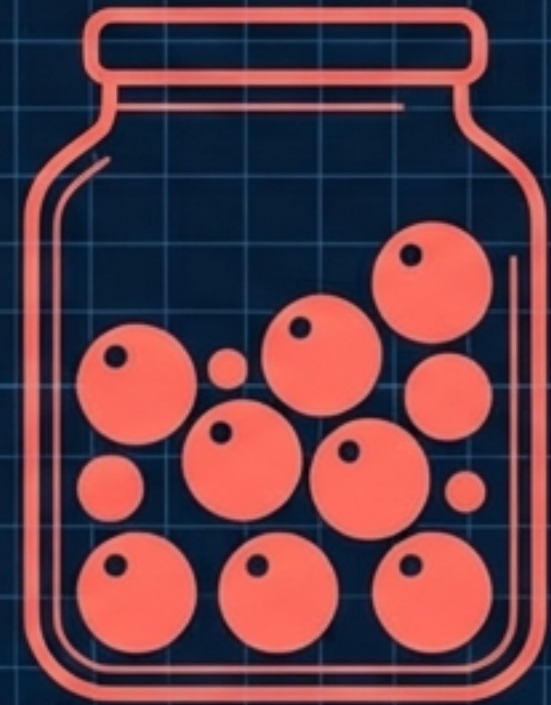
Grouping



Chronological Listing
(1990, 1991, 1992...)



Paragraph A
(Decreasing Trends)



Paragraph B
(Increasing Trends)

- Don't list chronologically.
- Group by Category (Ups vs. Downs).
- Group by Magnitude (Highs vs. Lows).

STEP 4: STOP DESCRIBING. START COMPARING.

Company A	\$10m
Company B	\$20m

RELATIONSHIP?

Describing (Bad):
Company A made \$10m.
Company B made \$20m.



Comparing (Good):
Company B earned **twice as much as** Company A.



The Examiner wants the relationship, not just the data.

ADVANCED COMPARISON TOOLKIT

Connectors

- Whereas
- In contrast
- While
- Followed by

Comparatives

- Higher than
- The most significant
- Less popular
- Twice as much as

Advanced Structures

- X peaked at [number], **before falling** to...
- **Similar to** X, Y also experienced...
- X is **double the figure** for Y.

PRECISION VOCABULARY (VERBS + ADVERBS)



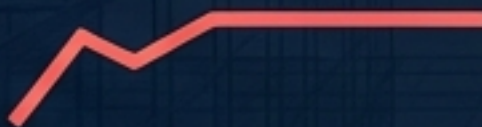
Soar



Plummet



Fluctuate



Stabilize

Avoid: "It went up a lot."

Use: "It **increased dramatically**."

COMMON BAND 6 TRAPS



Writing a
Conclusion.



Describing
Every Line.



Personal
Opinions
("Because...")

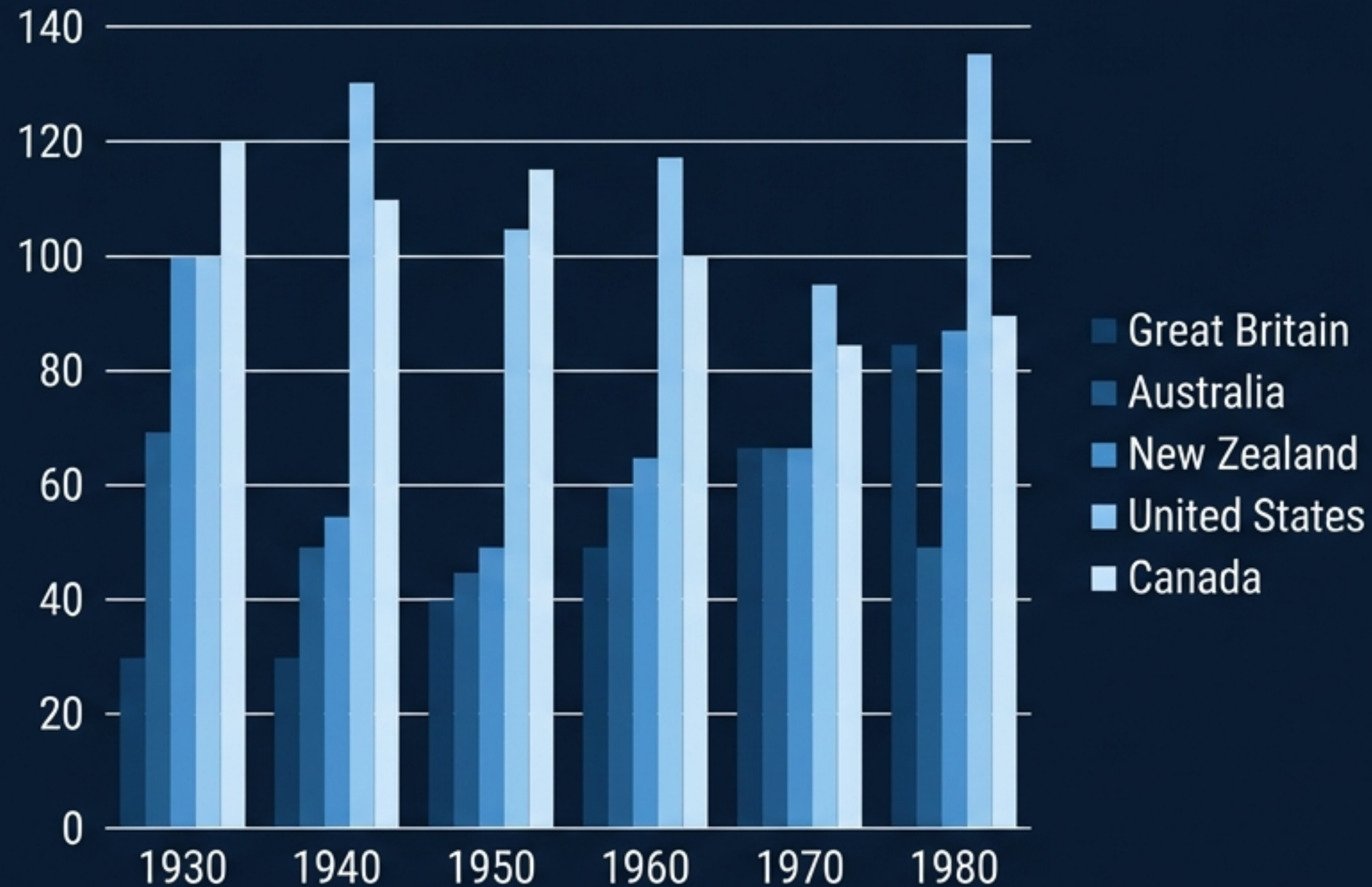


Wrong
Tense.



Repetitive
Vocab.

YOUR TURN: THE 5-MINUTE CHALLENGE



Task: Write ONLY the **Introduction** and **Overview**.

Time Limit: 5 Minutes.

- ☐ Did you paraphrase?
- ☐ Did you use 'Overall'?
- ☐ Did you avoid specific numbers in the overview?

Homework: Write the **full body** paragraphs using **comparison language**.